MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第15回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第15回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To protect nesting plovers along the gravel spit, beachgoers are asked to ( ) from flying kites or drones between April and July.

1 reclaim **2** refrain **3** retain **4** remain

(2) Although the mountain weather station operates without resident staff, its satellite transmitter sends snowpack data ( ) every fifteen minutes.

1 reluctantly **2** randomly **3** recklessly **4** reliably

(3) Because handmade rice paper blurs easily if ink pools, calligraphers practice ( ) brush pressure smoothly at the end of every stroke.

1 easing **2** erasing **3** erupting **4** evading

(4) The harbor symphony moved Sunday's brass concert indoors ( ) sudden squalls forecast across the bay.

1 in quest of **2** in place of **3** in view of **4** in terms of

(5) Before exporting dried shiitake mushrooms overseas, the agricultural cooperative has random cartons ( ) for moisture content and aroma.

1 tempted **2** tested **3** tended **4** tilted

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Urban cyclists are understandably (　　) to use painted bike lanes when delivery trucks park across them every few blocks.

1 humble　**2** hostile　**3** hesitant　**4** hollow

(7) Switching classroom projectors from halogen bulbs to laser diodes brought a sharp (　　) in replacement costs and fan noise.

1 reflection　**2** reception　**3** rebellion　**4** reduction

(8) Little (　　) the amateur fossil hunter suspect that the grey pebble in her palm was the jawbone of a Cretaceous seabird.

1 did　**2** had　**3** was　**4** has

(9) To keep freshly cut hydrangeas vibrant during wedding banquets, florists sear stem tips briefly so air bubbles cannot (　　) water uptake.

1 herald　**2** harbor　**3** hasten　**4** hinder

(10) After analyzing five years of deer-collision reports, highway engineers (　　) wildlife warning reflectors along three misty mountain curves.

1 insulted　**2** installed　**3** inferred　**4** inhaled

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Although both ferry routes cross the same strait, the catamaran rides (　　) smoother in choppy autumn swells than the flat-bottomed barge.

1 casually　**2** coincidentally　**3** considerably　**4** clumsily

(12) Because insulin pens lose potency if frozen inside checked airplane luggage, diabetic travelers keep medication in carry-on bags (　　) at cabin temperature.

1 maintained　**2** magnified　**3** multiplied　**4** mobilized

(13) To (　　) collaboration between engineering and nursing students, the university opened a shared prototyping lab on the ground floor.

1 falter　**2** foster　**3** forbid　**4** frighten

(14) Even when automatic spell-checkers flag zero errors, editors read galley proofs aloud to pick (　　) awkward rhythms or missing words.

1 up　**2** off　**3** on　**4** over

(15) Local stone masons worked all winter to shore (　　) the castle's leaning east rampart before spring thaw softened the moat bank.

1 away　**2** off　**3** out　**4** up

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) All waterproof jackets tested by the mountaineering magazine were rated for breathability as well as seam (　　).

1 digestion　**2** duplication　**3** durability　**4** hesitation

(17) Rather than expand parking lots at the canyon entrance, park officials launched free shuttle buses to (　　) holiday traffic jams.

1 aggravate　**2** alleviate　**3** allocate　**4** alienate

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Concert Pianists Care About Bench Height

Watch a solo pianist walk onstage before a concerto, and you may see the performer spend thirty seconds turning dual side knobs on the padded bench—testing a single chord, rising slightly, and adjusting the seat by barely half a centimeter before nodding to the conductor. Audience members sometimes read this ritual as nervous perfectionism, yet biomechanics specialists say millimeter changes in bench height transform both tone production and injury risk.

Unlike typing at an office laptop, playing grand-piano repertoire demands transferring upper-body weight fluidly through relaxed shoulders, forearms, and finger pads into eighty-eight weighted wooden keys. If a bench sits two centimeters too low, a pianist must shrug the shoulders upward or bend the wrists below key level, choking leverage during thunderous chords and straining forearm tendons over two-hour programs. (18), perching too high forces the player to hunch forward, tiring lower-back muscles and making delicate soft passages harder to control.

Pedal geometry complicates the equation further. Taller pianists with long legs often push the bench slightly farther back from the keyboard so their right ankle can pivot smoothly on the damper pedal without cramping, which in turn changes elbow angles at the keys. Backstage technicians at major halls therefore keep numbered hydraulic or screw benches logged by artist preference. (19), traveling soloists who play different pianos every week carry a pocket tape measure to match seat-to-key distance precisely.

Those quiet turns of a bench knob before the first note show how musical artistry (20).

(18)

1 For example
2 Therefore
3 As a result
4 Conversely

(19)

1 Likewise
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 In vain

(20)

1 requires every pianist to use the exact same bench height
2 sounds identical regardless of how a performer sits
3 depends on sound ergonomics as much as emotional expression
4 eliminates forearm movement by locking the wrists stiffly

How Floating Solar Panels Help Water Reservoirs

Countries rich in sunshine often face a painful land-use dilemma as renewable energy expands: flat sunny valleys ideal for ground-mounted solar farms are frequently the very fields most prized for growing rice, vegetables, or orchard fruit. Over the past decade, water authorities in Japan, South Korea, Singapore, and California have found clever relief on surfaces already shaped by human engineering—agricultural irrigation ponds and municipal drinking-water reservoirs.

By mooring buoyant high-density polyethylene pontoons across ten to thirty percent of an artificial reservoir, utilities create "floatovoltaics" without felling a single forest tree or displacing a farm plot. Water and silicon panels form a mutually beneficial match. Just as rooftop vegetation cools air beneath panels, open water underneath floating arrays moderates summer operating temperatures, boosting electrical yield during heat waves. (21), shading part of the reservoir surface cuts wind-driven evaporation—saving thousands of cubic meters of precious irrigation water during dry summers—and limits sunlight that fuels foul-tasting blue-green algae blooms.

Engineers are careful not to blanket natural lakes wholesale. Covering an entire natural pond could block oxygen exchange or disturb diving waterfowl, so floating arrays are steered toward lined industrial basins, quarry lakes, and dam reservoirs, leaving wide shoreline zones open. (22), cables and anchors must be designed to ride five-meter seasonal water-level swings without chafing.

Used thoughtfully on human-made waters, floating solar arrays allow regions short on flat land to (23).

(21)

1 On the contrary
2 In return
3 Previously
4 Otherwise

(22)

1 In vain
2 For instance
3 At the same time
4 Instead

(23)

1 drain drinking-water reservoirs to build shopping malls
2 encourage blue-green algae blooms during summer droughts
3 cover every wild mountain lake from shore to shore
4 harvest clean electricity while conserving water and farmland

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Costume Laundry Rules After the Autumn Opera Run

From: Wardrobe Mistress, Naomi Kudo
To: Student Chorus and Stage Crew
Subject: Returning velvet tunics and wool cloaks after Sunday's final curtain

Congratulations on three sold-out performances! Before everyone rushes home after Sunday's matinee curtain call, please read this important costume-care reminder.

Please do NOT take your velvet chorus tunic or lined wool cloak home to wash in a household machine, even on a gentle cold cycle. Water shrinks wool interlinings unevenly and crushes velvet pile permanently, which cost our theater club four bespoke jackets two years ago.

Instead, hang your costume inside-out on its numbered wooden hanger right after changing, clip any loose buttons into the small mesh pouch on the hook, and leave it on the rolling rack outside Dressing Room B by 5:30 p.m. Our costume vendor will dry-clean all outer garments together on Monday. Washable cotton undershirts, however, should go home with you and return clean on Thursday.

Naomi Kudo

Costume Laundry Rules After the Autumn Opera Run — Questions

(24) Why are chorus members forbidden to wash velvet tunics or wool cloaks at home?

1 Water shrinks wool linings unevenly and ruins velvet texture permanently.

2 Household detergent turns all buttons bright green.

3 Dressing Room B has industrial washing machines for wool.

4 The costumes are rented from a foreign museum for one afternoon.

(25) How should students prepare their outer costumes before leaving them outside Dressing Room B?

1 Fold them into plastic bags with wet towels.

2 Mail them directly to the dry cleaner on Tuesday.

3 Sew new zippers onto every cloak before 5:30 p.m.

4 Hang them inside-out on numbered wooden hangers and place any loose buttons in the hook pouch.

(26) Which item ARE students expected to wash at home and return on Thursday?

1 Velvet chorus tunics.

2 Cotton undershirts.

3 Numbered wooden hangers.

4 Lined wool cloaks.

How Porous Pavement Tames Urban Flash Floods

When an intense summer thunderstorm dumps fifty millimeters of rain onto a forested hillside, spongy leaf litter and tree-root channels soak up most of the downpour, releasing clear water slowly into streams over days. Drop that same cloudburst onto a conventional city neighborhood—where roofs, parking lots, and asphalt streets seal eighty percent of the ground—and rainwater has nowhere to sink. Torrents race across oily pavement into storm drains within minutes, overwhelming sewer pipes, flooding underpasses, and flushing tire dust and litter straight into urban rivers.

Rather than digging ever-wider concrete storm tunnels beneath crowded streets, civil engineers are redesigning pavement itself to mimic forest soil. Conventional asphalt and concrete mix coarse gravel with fine sand that packs every tiny gap shut. Pervious concrete and porous asphalt, by contrast, deliberately omit fine sand particles, leaving an interconnected honeycomb of air voids—roughly twenty percent of the slab's volume—through which rainwater drains straight downward into a thick crushed-stone reservoir bed underneath.

Beneath parking bays, plazas, and low-speed residential lanes, that gravel bed acts as both sponge and biofilter. Stormwater pauses among irregular stone surfaces for hours before seeping into native subsoil or perforated overflow pipes, shaving dangerous flood peaks during cloudbursts. Meanwhile, naturally occurring bacteria coating the stones break down trace motor-oil hydrocarbons, and cooler moisture evaporating after storms trims surface pavement heat.

Porous surfaces are not maintenance-free miracles, nor do they suit eighty-kilometer-per-hour truck highways where heavy braking shears open-graded stone loose. Without semiannual cleaning by vacuum sweeper trucks, windblown silt and autumn leaves can clog surface pores within a few years—and well-meaning crews must never sealcoat porous lots with black tar.

Matched to the right streets and upkeep schedules, however, permeable paving turns acres of hard city crust back into living watershed.

How Porous Pavement Tames Urban Flash Floods — Questions

(27) Why do summer cloudbursts trigger flash floods much faster in paved cities than on forested hillsides?

1 City clouds drop boiling water instead of ordinary rain.

2 Forest trees pump river water uphill onto highways.

3 Roofs and sealed asphalt stop rain from soaking in, sending torrents into storm drains within minutes.

4 Urban storm drains are filled solid with concrete every May.

(28) How is porous asphalt or pervious concrete mixed differently from conventional pavement?

1 Fine sand is left out so interconnected air spaces let water drain straight through to a stone bed.

2 Powdered glass and cooking oil are added to make tires slide.

3 Steel sheets are bolted across the top to block all water.

4 Wooden planks replace gravel entirely.

(29) Besides slowing flood runoff, what water-quality benefit does the crushed-stone bed provide?

1 It turns rainwater into carbonated mineral water for cafés.

2 Bacteria living on the stones help break down trace motor oil washed off vehicles.

3 It heats stormwater to ninety degrees to kill weeds.

4 It adds road salt to streams in July.

(30) What limitation or maintenance requirement of porous pavement is noted in paragraph four?

1 Surface pores can clog with silt and leaves unless cleaned periodically with vacuum sweepers.

2 It must be coated with thick black tar every spring.

3 It works ONLY on eighty-kilometer-per-hour truck highways.

4 Vacuum sweeper trucks shatter porous concrete on contact.

How Porous Pavement Tames Urban Flash Floods — Questions (continued)

(31) What overall conclusion does the author reach about permeable paving?

1 Conventional sealed asphalt is always superior in residential parking lots.

2 Cities should pave over remaining forests so rainwater reaches rivers faster.

3 Pervious concrete eliminates the need for all municipal maintenance crews.

4 When placed on suitable streets and maintained properly, it helps cities manage rain like natural watersheds.